

ware for Windows and Windows Mobile to move on to Windows Phone and Windows 8.

Raja and Shanti picked iOS because the iPhone was the first smartphone they used and they “fell in love with it.” They also preferred the iOS audience who were more likely to spend on an app. Rahul saw the potential of Windows Phone and the convergent future that Microsoft has promised with Windows 8 and Windows Phone 8.

Biggest pitfalls of working as an independent developer

All five had different experiences to share from their time as indie developers. For Sreekanth, the biggest drawback is the absence of a team and the relationships you develop when working with a team. Rahul revealed that another drawback of working as a solo developer was that he didn't have a second/third-party whose experience he could count on, especially with respect to things he wasn't so great at like design. Nirmitt pointed to the difficulty in getting freelance projects as an indie developer especially without a strong portfolio and experience, both of which take time to build upon.

Raja and Shanti made an interesting observation about how developers expect their work to end when the app is complete. However, through their experience, they realised that without a marketing plan, their app got lost in the crowd, especially one as huge as the one in the Apple App Store. They stressed on the importance of things like building a dedicated website, creating demo videos of the app, reaching out to review sites and even making the app free for a limited time to generate buzz, in order to get the kind of download numbers that stand out.

Financial stability as an independent developer

Sreekanth said that a developer working on services can expect a semblance of financial stability by pursuing multiple projects that can generate consistent cash flow. However, developing products (read: individual apps) is risky and all the developer can hope is for the product to be noticed by a large number of users and generate some cash.

Nirmitt stressed on choosing the right platform to ensure quick monetization for apps. However, where platforms like iOS and Android may seem like they would be easier to make money off, even a burgeoning platform like Windows Phone could be monetized by someone with patience and a good sense of what works and what doesn't. Raja and Shanti had a similar